

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	Ground Penetrating Radar (GPR) – SAFE OPERATION	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Signature: 			
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	 Signature
			<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L <i>Likely</i>	M <i>Moderate</i>	U <i>Unlikely</i>
H (1) <i>(High level of harm)</i>	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) <i>(High)</i>	1	1	2
M (2) <i>(Medium level of harm)</i>	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) <i>(Medium)</i>	1	2	3
L (3) <i>(Low level of harm)</i>	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) <i>(Low)</i>	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

- | |
|---|
| Level 1
Eliminate the hazard |
| Level 2
Substitute the hazard with something safer. |
| Level 3
Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls. |
| Level 4
Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions. |
| Level 5
Use personal protective equipment |
| The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned |

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
General Safety Requirements	Personal injury to operator and other workers.	1	1. All persons who are to operate or assist with the operation of the radar are to be fully competent and have received information and instruction in the safe use of the radar and the potential hazards. 2. Read all instructions before using GPR. 3. Be familiar with controls and operating manual. 4. Do not work in rain or during thunderstorms. 5. Operator and any assistant to wear appropriate PPE – safety boots, safety glasses, long clothing, safety vests (done up to prevent entanglement) gloves, hearing protection where necessary and safety helmets where required.	Operator	2
Set out work area.	Struck by road or construction plant.	1	1. Barricade area off to restrict inadvertent access to GPR path and minimise plant working area as appropriate. 2. All workers to wear safety vests or highly visible clothing. 3. Operational flashing lights and reversing beepers on all surrounding plant. 4. Where working near roadsides or other hazardous areas a spotter or traffic control may be required to maintain awareness of hazards as operator is focusing on GPR orientation and readout.	Supervisor All Operator	2
Pre start checks GPR and associated equipment	Unsafe Radar potential for injury to operator or bystanders	1	1. Pre start checks are to be completed as per the operations manual and documented as such. Work on slopes greater than 25 degrees must be in accordance with the requirements below.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Operating the GPR	Manual handling Slips, trips, falls	1	1. Unload GPR with care whilst using safe lifting techniques 2. Push GPR smoothly 3. Avoid any twisting and side-bending during process 4. Bend knees and not back when carrying or using equipment. 5. Avoid awkward and sustained positions. 6. Ensure GPR equipment does not create a trip hazard.	Operators	2
Inspection of work site Determine where work is to be carried out and what equipment is required	Slips, trips and falls, access and egress, work at height, UV exposure, heat, cold, rain	1	1. Be aware of surrounding at all times 2. Be aware of out access and egress areas Wear appropriate sun protection 3. Stop outdoor works at the onset of rain 4. Any work within 2 metres of an edge required a harness or barricades to be in place	Operators	2
Roll GPR over surfaces and mark services/post tensions cables with Spray Mark paint for client excavating/ drilling for core holes	Tripping, slips and falls, Work from height, Air quality, Head, hand, foot & body injury. Falls, fumes inhalation	1	1. Ensure all site personnel have been instructed in the correct use of the equipment. 2. All equipment and tools to be in good serviceable condition. 3. PPE (steel cap boots, gloves, safety glasses, Hi Vis shirt) to be used. 4. If working from an EWP the operator must have a VOC. 5. When required safety harnesses will be worn and properly attached. 6. All scanning equipment will be positioned within EWP to prevent falls. 7. If working within 2 meter of an edge either a harness must be attached and worn or barricades must be put up to prevent falls. 8. When using spray paint to mark lines, only us in well ventilated areas.	Operators	2

Work on slopes	Working on an inclined slope greater than 25 degrees.	1	1. Ensure footwear is securely laced, zips secured 2. Work on slopes of this kind must never be undertaken alone 3. Survey area prior to unpacking GPR 4. Identify all fragile sloped areas, slips trips, and falls with traffic cones/hazard tape/marker paint prior to taking in equipment 7. All work ceases in adverse weather events (strong wind/any rain) 8. All objects capable of falling from slopes must be restrained or secured consult Compliance Manager (CM) 9. Warning Signs to be placed below slope if pedestrians are below 10. Full PPE to be adorned Hard hats, Safety Glasses & Safety Boots 11. Traffic management may be required where vehicular traffic is below the slope - Consult CM 12. Work on slopes requiring the use of ladders or scaffolding will need express approval from CM prior to undertaking	Operators	2
Work in Hazardous Areas	Hazardous or Gaseous Environments	1	1. Hydrocarbon, Oxygen & H2S alarms on person at all times 2. If alarms sound all work is to cease immediately, move to emergency assembly point and contact CM 3. All PPE must be 100% cotton or intrinsically safe to avoid static 4. Organic/Inorganic Respirators or AB Flow helmets to be used if and where required – Contact CM	Operators & Compliance Manager	2

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory Helmets if and when required	
Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.						
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card						
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management			
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training	Fire Extinguisher training	Fatigue Management Training			
A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.						
Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)						
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2012						
Codes of Practice and Other Guides						
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018			
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 220	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019			
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018			
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018			
Guide for Managing Risks from High Pressure Water Jetting – Safe Work Aust 2022						
Plant & Equipment for this activity						
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily maintenance & service checks. - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.						
List of plant for this Activity						
CCTV Camera						
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):						

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.